

Why are people suddenly complaining about data centers using a lot of water and energy because of AI? When massive data centers have been a thing for at least a couple of decades now. No one really complained then.

Posted by u/mmmofrki • 0 points • 89 comments

MySpace, Facebook, YouTube all required a ton of energy to store and process data even back during their launch days.

Yet no one really questioned this at all.

I mean as far back as AOL, the only thing they were criticized for was the mass sending of CDs and horrible retention practices.

But suddenly AI becomes a thing and now everyone is concerned about the environment and water and all of that.

Why? Why now?

Is it because people just loved using YouTube and other sites when the internet basically became unlimited and people weren't charged by the hour?

Comments

u/Garrett_Mancuso • 1 points • 2026-01-17 19:07 UTC

That's an apples to oranges comparison. The data center being built in my state will require more electricity than is produced by my state's only nuclear plant. Our power bill has increased 40%, and it's not our power consumption. I'm paying to build the infrastructure for a 6.2m sq foot data center that will never benefit my state. But please, tell me how it's because I stream music or listen to podcast while I work,

u/Ok_Marionberry_656 • 1 points • 2025-11-16 10:40 UTC

They should not be a public burden. Put all the costs on the owner. The public should not be paying for high transmission infrastructure they are not using or be subsidizing their energy bills when they consume the majority of power.

u/Noah-Buddy-I-Know • 1 points • 2025-10-14 01:13 UTC

Cause more are being built today, and they are contributing to skyrocketing energy prices for local residents.

u/Adverity • 1 points • 2025-09-18 03:35 UTC

New AI data centers use significantly more water than older data centers because AI's high computational demands generate more heat, requiring more powerful cooling systems that consume greater volumes of water. AI servers also have higher power densities, leading to more intense cooling needs and higher water consumption for evaporation and humidity control, particularly in water-scarce regions where many new data centers are located

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-01-13 21:17 UTC

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u/IIIIMaintenance145142 • 1 points • 2025-09-08 12:22 UTC

Because to the average person, ai is basically useless in their day to day life. It's more enshittification than anything they actually want. People want entertainment, so streaming is a worthy sacrifice. Running entire data centres for something people genuinely just don't care about, I can understand the negative sentiment, and I don't see how you can't, even if you don't agree with it necessarily